## MC 451 Codebook and Qualitative Memo rubric

**50 points.** Due Friday, October 30, 11:59 PM.

**How this is scored.** Add the points from each row; the total is out of 50. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Length: the codebook 800 to 1,500 words, counting its variable and example tables, and the memo 200 to 300 words. Word counts cover your own writing, not the title, headings, tables, references, figure captions, code, or output, and writing more than the range never costs points. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Work at two-thirds or more of the minimum length counts as showing effort. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- The codebook rows total 35 and the memo 15. The two parts are graded together as one 50-point assignment.
- Safeguards to choose from: writing every category's inclusion and exclusion rule before coding begins; two or three prototypical examples per category drawn from your material; freezing the codebook before the full pass and logging every later change with its date and reason; keeping an ambiguous-case memo and settling each case against the written rule instead of by feel; coding in a fixed order with source details hidden wherever that is possible.

*Codebook and Qualitative Memo, 50 points*

| Criterion | Exemplary | Proficient | Developing | Beginning |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Codebook: study overview**<br>3 points | **3 points.** Three to four sentences naming the question, the material you are coding, and the time period. | **2 points.** Names two of the three. | **1 point.** Present, but a reader still could not say what is being coded or from when. | **0 points.** Missing. |
| **Codebook: unit of analysis**<br>8 points | **8 points.** States exactly what one coded item is (one message, one post, one minute of video), once, and every variable is coded on that item. | **6 to 7 points.** Stated, but a variable is coded on something else (for example, the unit is one message but a variable describes the whole stream). | **4 to 5 points.** Stated loosely ("the comments", "the content"), so a reader could not tell where one item ends and the next begins. | **0 to 3 points.** Not stated. |

| Criterion | Exemplary | Proficient | Developing | Beginning |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Codebook: every variable**<br>5 points | **5 points.** Every variable carries all five elements: conceptual definition, operational definition, level of measurement, coded values, and edge-case rules. | **4 points.** Every variable is here, but one or two are missing an element. | **3 points.** Several variables are missing elements, or a variable is listed by name only. | **0 to 2 points.** Variables are named without definitions. |
| **Codebook: decision rules**<br>7 points | **7 points.** Rules for the cases that do not sort themselves, each written as a rule ("If a message both praises and insults, code the first clause"), covering the hard calls you actually met. | **5 to 6 points.** Rules are there, but at least one is an intention instead of a rule, or a hard case you mention has no rule. | **4 points.** One or two rules for the whole codebook. | **0 to 3 points.** None. |
| **Codebook: examples**<br>5 points | **5 points.** Two or three examples per category, taken from your own material, each one clearly belonging to its category. | **4 points.** Examples for every category, but some are invented or there is only one per category. | **3 points.** Examples for some categories only. Without examples a rule is hard to use for anyone who was not in your head when you wrote it. | **0 to 2 points.** No examples. |

| Criterion | Exemplary | Proficient | Developing | Beginning |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Codebook: single-coder note**<br>7 points | **7 points.** Three short paragraphs: you say in plain words that you are the only coder and every reliability claim is about your own consistency; you name at least three safeguards you are using; and you give the second-coder counterfactual (how many items you would double-code, what number you would report, how you would train and settle disagreements, which finding is most at risk). | **5 to 6 points.** All three parts are there, but one is thin: fewer than three safeguards, or the counterfactual skips which finding is at risk. | **4 points.** Names the limitation but not the safeguards or the counterfactual, or describes a second coder as if one were part of the study. | **0 to 3 points.** Missing, or says nothing about being the only coder. |
| **Qualitative memo**<br>15 points | **15 points.** 200 to 300 words on the patterns you saw while immersed in your material, and each codebook category traces back to something the memo describes seeing. | **11 to 14 points.** Describes real patterns, but one or two categories cannot be traced back to anything in the memo. | **8 to 10 points.** Describes the topic in general instead of what you saw, or runs under 200 words, which usually means the link from what you saw to each category is missing: name the pattern behind each category. | **0 to 7 points.** A summary of the topic or the plan, with no patterns from your own watching or reading. |

### Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted codebook and reports what this assignment asks for that your draft does not have yet: a unit of analysis stated once, both definitions on every variable, a declared level of measurement, a catch-all category, a description on every category, category pairs that may overlap, decision rules, and examples. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.